

Acid–Base Titration Curves

Answer key with worked solutions

A. Understanding

1. Equivalence point vs end point.

The **equivalence point** is where the moles of base added exactly match the moles of acid (from the balanced equation). The **end point** is where the indicator changes colour. A good indicator makes them almost the same.

2. Equivalence-point pH.

(a) **Equal to 7**: strong acid + strong base. (b) **Above 7**: weak acid + strong base (formate is weakly basic). (c) **Below 7**: strong acid + weak base (NH_4^+ is weakly acidic).

B. Strong acid with strong base

3. Equivalence volume.

Moles HCl = $0.150 \times 0.02000 = 0.00300$ mol. Volume NaOH = $0.00300 \div 0.100 = 30.0$ mL

4. Initial pH.

$\text{pH} = -\log(0.150) = 0.82$

5. After 10.00 mL NaOH.

NaOH added = 0.00100 mol; HCl left = $0.00300 - 0.00100 = 0.00200$ mol in 30.00 mL. $[\text{H}_3\text{O}^+] = 0.0667$ M; $\text{pH} = 1.18$

6. After 40.00 mL NaOH.

NaOH added = 0.00400 mol; excess $\text{OH}^- = 0.00400 - 0.00300 = 0.00100$ mol in 60.00 mL. $[\text{OH}^-] = 0.0167$ M; $\text{pOH} = 1.78$; $\text{pH} = 12.22$

C. Weak acids and indicators

7. pKa and Ka from the half-equivalence point.

At half-equivalence, pH = pKa, so **pKa = 4.20** and $K_a = 10^{-4.20} = \mathbf{6.3 \times 10^{-5}}$

8. Indicator choice.

Phenolphthalein (pH 8.2–10.0). The equivalence point of a weak acid–strong base titration is above 7, inside the steep jump where phenolphthalein changes colour. Methyl orange would change far too early.